

Internship Candidate Manual



This manual is intended for those who have been approved as candidates for internship through the interview process. It provides detailed information on the procedures and precautions involved in the internship. For an overview of IAESTE, the internship and the application process, please refer to the Application Guidelines.

Contents

I. Procedures after approval as an intern candidate	
1. Transfer of the internship administration fee	2
2. Submission of the letter of commitment, etc.	2
3. Notes on communication with the Japan Office	3
II. Matching	
1. Matching method	3
2. Procedure for downloading the matched offer	3
3. Notes on the offer description	3
4. Title of the email to be sent to the Japan Office	4
III. Submitting the nomination documents	
1. Operating procedures of the EP	4
2. Breakdown of Nomination documents and preparation method	4
IV. Acceptance/rejection decisions of the host institution and procedures after the decision to accept	
1. Up to the acceptance/rejection decision	6
2. Notification of acceptance or rejection	6
3. Procedures after acceptance decision	6
V. Preliminary procedures and preparations	
1. Obtaining a visa and work permit	7
2. Purchase airline tickets	7
3. Purchase travel insurance	7
4. Preparation for accommodation	7
5. Confirmation of accommodation	7
6. Improvement of language skills	7
7. Make an emergency contact list	7
VI. From pre-departure to end of internship	
1. Before departure	8
2. Arrival in the host country	8
3. During the internship period	8
4. Completion of internship and return to Japan	8
VII. In case that the internship is not implemented	
1. Refund of internship administration fee	9
2. Notification of withdrawal	9
Attachment: “IAESTE Language Certificate” form	
※For cases where this document is required, please refer to “Certificate of English language proficiency” on page 5.	

Contents of the Application Guidelines in April

I. About IAESTE	2
II. Overview of IAESTE Internships	6
III. Flow up to the internship confirmation	8
IV. List of fields of internship	9

I. Procedures after approval as an intern candidate

1. Transfer of the internship administration fee

(1) Amount

The amount of the internship administration fee depends on whether you are enrolled at an IAESTE university member school*1.

University member school student: 50,000 yen

Non-member students: 100,000 yen

*1: The current university members are the following 15 universities.

Osaka University, Okayama University, Kyoto University, Keio University, University of Tokyo, Institute of Science Tokyo, Tokyo Metropolitan University, Tokyo University of Agriculture and Technology, Tokyo University of Science, Doshisha University, Tohoku University, Muroran Institute of Technology, Yokohama National University, Ritsumeikan University, Waseda University

*2: The amount for those who have previously undertaken an IAESTE internship course is half of the above.

(2) Bank transfer account

Please make a bank transfer in the applicant's name (in katakana) to the account below.

The original bank transfer details must be kept by the applicant. No receipt will be issued.

Beneficiary Bank and Branch Name	Bank of Mitsubishi UFJ, Sugamo Branch (Branch No. 770)
Account No.	Savings, 0000925
Beneficiary Name	Japan International Association for the Exchange of Students for Technical Experience

(3) Deadline

Exchange Internship applicants in September must make payment by **5 November** of the current year.

Note: If payment cannot be confirmed by the deadline, the intern candidate's qualification will be regarded as abandoned.

Global Internship applicants are requested to transfer the funds as soon as they find an offer they wish to apply for, and send a copy of the transfer and the reference number of the offer to the Japan Office by email.

2. Submission of the letter of commitment, etc.

Exchange Internship applicants in September must submit the following two files to the Japan Office by email no later than **5 November** of the current year.

Note: Incomplete or late submission of documents will be regarded as a cancellation of the intern candidate's rights.

(1) Pledge form

Download from the IAESTE Japan website, fill in, sign the form, and create a PDF file.

The internship administration fee will not be refunded for any reason in case of violation of the statements and rules.

(2) Receipt of the transfer of the internship administration fee

Create a PDF file of the bank transfer receipt (or ATM statement).

3. Notes on communication with the Japan Office

The deadline for replying to emails requiring a response from the Japan Office is one week. Please note that if this deadline is exceeded, the candidate may be regarded to have 'declined for personal reasons' (see p. 9).

Please inform in advance if you will not be able to check your email for a long period.

Inform us immediately if there are any changes to your address, telephone number or email address.

II. Matching

As registration on the EP (Exchange Platform) is completed at the time of application, this section describes the subsequent operations on the EP.

The registration procedure for the EP is described in “VI. Application procedure, 6.Registration on the Exchange Platform (EP)” in the Application Guide.

1. Matching method

(1) For Exchange Internship applicants

Acquired offers will be matched to each intern candidate on the EP at the end of February in the following year (according to the current schedule).

(2) For Global Internship applicants

Please find an offer that meets your requirements from the daily available offers on the EP and contact the Japan Office with the reference number. The offer will be matched immediately.

2. Procedure for downloading the matched offer

#1. Click on Internships in the top right-hand corner of the EP

#2. Click on “ASSIGNED”.

#3. The Reference Number of the matched offer will be displayed.

#4. Click on the PDF mark on the right.

3. Notes on the offer description

(1) The first page of the internship offer is the O-form, and the second page contains notes, etc. The pages after the second page vary from country to country. Unless anything special is attached, please follow this manual to prepare Nomination documents.

(2) For German offers

For the certificate of enrolment, download and use the Certificate of Enrolment form attached to the EP. Fill in all the required fields in English and get the signature and stamp of the person in charge or the professor in charge of the international department or faculty at the university. (Certificate of Enrolment issued by the university is not required).

If you will not be able to obtain the certificate until April because you are going on to graduate school, please inform the Japan Office when you upload the Nomination form.

The duration of the internship must always be "Starts on the 1st and ends on the last day of the month".

(3) For Polish offers

Please state that you are "enrolled at the University until the end of the internship" by adding the following at the bottom of the university's certificate of enrolment.

"Expected end of study: March, 202X" (where 202X is the year of expected completion of university, handwritten or typed).

4. Title of the email to be sent to the Japan Office

Please set the subject line of your email to our office in the following format: “Offer Reference No._Your Name.”

Example: DE-2025-1000-1_Taro Yamada_

III. Submitting the nomination documents

1. Operating procedures of the EP

- (1) Log in to the EP.
- (2) Go to [Personal Information] ⇒ [Study Information] ⇒ [Working Related information] and enter the information as instructed.
- (3) Upload a scanned copy of your passport to the [scanned copy of passport] tab.
- (4) Generate a PDF file of the Student Nomination Form.
- (5) Send the Nomination documents to the Japan Office.

For Exchange Internship applicants:

Combine all Nomination documents into one PDF file and send it by the deadline (1 March).

*After the documents have been checked, the Japan Office will upload the Nomination documents to the EP. If this is not done in time for the EP deadline, the offer will be automatically cancelled. Please meet the deadline strictly to avoid this, which is scheduled for 1 March in the following year, but may change depending on changes to the IAESTE A.s.b.l. timetable.

*If you cannot complete your documents until after April in the following year, e.g. due to postgraduate study, please indicate this in the email text when sending the documents to the Japan Office.

For Global Internship applicants:

There is no default deadline and you should meet the deadline specified for each offer. The Japan Office will contact you as necessary according to the deadlines of each offer.

(The Japan Office is closed on Saturdays, Sundays and public holidays.)

After these, the Japan Office will forward the Nomination documents to the host country's IAESTE. If you wish to add additional documents after April, please email the Japan Office as soon as you have them.

2. Breakdown of Nomination documents and preparation method

Unless there are special notes on the Nomination documents, please prepare the following documents, integrate them into a single PDF file of uniform size A4 and email to Japan Office.

Example for German offers: "DE-2026-○○○○_Taro_Yamada"

(“DE” is the country code for Germany).

If you are applying for architecture and design offers, you must submit a portfolio.

(1) Student Nominated Form.

Please enter your personal details in the EP and click on the GENERATE tab. If you are unsure, please read the EP's Student Guide.

(2) Internship Offer (abbreviated as O-form or Form-O)

(3) Motivation Letter (Cover Letter)

It is the Motivation Letter that demonstrates the advantages of accepting you as an intern to the person in charge of the host institution, and this impression will have a significant impact on the decision. The application form is also checked for English language skills, so please be cautious of spelling and grammatical errors.

In principle, it should be a single page of A4 paper and is advised to be prepared in accordance with the following guidelines.

Name and address of the host institution (as shown on the O-Form)

Dear Name of the person in charge at the host institution, (if the person in charge is unknown, use To whom it may concern,)

Your own contact address.

The following is shown paragraph by paragraph.

- (1) Self introduction. Which university you are a student at and what you specialize in (what you are studying), etc.
- (2) Give specific reasons why you are interested in the offer you are applying for, what particularly interests you, etc.
- (3) Describe your suitability for the offer you are applying for. Give specific details of your field of expertise, etc.
- (4) State the level of your skills to meet the requirements of the host institution (see 'Other requirements' on the offer), language skills, etc.
- (5) State any other things about yourself that appeal to the employer. (e.g. hobbies, club activities, skills acquired through part-time work, etc.). (This section should be used in particular if there are special items that can be used to highlight your achievements.)
- (6) State how you would like to utilize the experience in the future (in terms of your studies, after graduation or after returning to Japan) after the internship.
- (7) Describe your image of the host country and why you chose it. (This content is essential).
- (8) State that you look forward to hearing from them and thank them for taking the time to read your application.

Yours sincerely,

Signature (Japanese characters are acceptable)

Type your name

(4) CV (Curriculum Vitae, English CV)

Show your experience and possible skills, as these are important for the acceptance or rejection decision of the host institution. It is advisable to provide details of your programming and CAD skills so that the level of your skills is clear.

(5) Certificate of enrolment (in English)

If you are entering a postgraduate school from a new term, submit a certificate of acceptance in English. (A copy of a Japanese certificate with your own English translation is also acceptable.)

(6) Transcript of academic achievements (in English)

(7) Certificate of English language proficiency

If there have been any updates to the score since the application procedure, submit the latest certificate.

If the "Language Required" field in the O-form is indicated using the CEFR levels ("A1, A2, B1, B2, C1, C2"), you must also submit a document certifying your language proficiency based on this standard. An "IAESTE Language Certificate" form is provided at the end of this document. Please ask your academic supervisor or another appropriate referee to complete it, and attach the PDF file to your proof of English proficiency.

(8) Passport

The passport must be valid for at least six months from the expected date of return after completion of the internship.

Please note that, as a rule, it is not accepted to change the period of internship due to reasons of the intern candidate: Take care when filling in the "Student Nominated Form" for the desired period of internship.

If you wish to change the duration of your internship, please negotiate directly with your host institution and report to the Japan Office after you have been accepted.

(9) Other documents to be prepared as required.

Some countries do not require "a letter of recommendation from a university or professor (in English)": But it will give a good impression if submitted.

IV. Acceptance/rejection decisions of the host institution and procedures after the decision to accept.

1. Up to the acceptance/rejection decision

The Japan Office sends the Nomination documents to the host country's IAESTE. It forwards them to the host institution, which makes the acceptance/rejection decision. It takes between one and three months before a notice of the result the decision.

In the meantime, you may receive an email directly from the host institution requesting a phone call or an online interview to confirm the candidate's field of study and English language skills. In such cases, reply as soon as possible to the email and take the interview.

If you have not heard from the host organization at least four weeks before the desired start date of the internship, please contact the Japan office.

2. Notification of acceptance or rejection

(1) In case of acceptance

The host country's IAESTE will upload the Acceptance Notes (N/5-A) to the EP, which will be forwarded to the candidate by the Japan Office.

The candidate is not allowed to contact the host country's IAESTE or the host institute directly until the acceptance notes are received. Direct contact may result in the candidate not being accepted.

Please purchase tickets only after receiving the Acceptance Notes (and obtaining a VISA if one is required). IAESTE and the host institution will not be held responsible in the unlikely event that the acceptance is cancelled after the ticket has been purchased before receipt.

(2) In case of non-acceptance

The host country's IAESTE will send you "Rejected" notification on the EP.

In the case of Exchange Internship

You lose the opportunity for an Exchange Internship and have the choice to change to a Global Internship or withdraw. If you chose to change to Global Internship, first contact the Japan Office, then search the EP's Available offer for your preferred offer to apply.

In the case of Global Internships

You can apply for a different Global Internship by searching for your preferred offer in the EP's Available offer and re-apply if you find one.

3. Procedures after acceptance decision

(1) Submission to the EP (upload or input)

Confirmation of Acceptance

The Confirmation of Acceptance is a signed and dated Confirmation of Acceptance under the Acceptance Notes that you have received. Upload this to the EP.

Arrival Information

In the Arrival Information tab of the EP, enter the required information at least two weeks before the start of the internship in principle. The items include flight arrival, overseas travel insurance, etc.

*The host country's IAESTE will prepare accommodation and pick-up arrangements according to the Arrival Information.

(2) Submission to the host country's IAESTE

The documents to be submitted depend on the host country.

If there are any changes to your flight or insurance, please inform us by email as soon as possible.

(3) Submission to the Japan Office

Please send a scanned copy of the certificate of overseas insurance coverage (with details of coverage in English) to the Japan Office by email.

If there are any changes to your flight or insurance, please inform us by email as soon as possible.

(4) Notes

After receiving the Letter of Acceptance, please contact IAESTE in your host country for any questions regarding your accommodation. (e.g. accommodation in the host country, how to pay for accommodation, visas, etc.)

V. Preliminary procedures and preparations

1. Obtaining a visa and work permit

Depending on the country and the length of stay (more than three months), it may be legally necessary to obtain a work permit.

If you need to obtain a work permit, please check the relevant documents sent to you by the host country's IAESTE and complete the procedures yourself with the support of the host country's IAESTE. You are responsible for all costs.

If the host country requires a VISA, after submitting your nomination documents, please check the visa and work permit information on the host country's IAESTE or the embassy's website.

The host country's IAESTE will prepare the VISA application documents and send them to you by e-mail. Apply as soon as you receive them.

2. Purchase airline tickets

Please make your own reservations and purchase airline tickets at your own risk.

3. Purchase travel insurance

You are obliged to take out travel insurance yourself. The period must be from the day of departure to the day of return (including outside the internship period).

If the host country's IAESTE specifies the contents and amount of coverage in its documentation, please follow the instructions.

4. Preparation for accommodation

The host institute or the host country's IAESTE will pay you an amount sufficient to enable you to live in the host country for the duration of the internship : Specific amounts are indicated on the O-form.

The host country may deduct taxes from the amount paid, so please check the O-form or the documents sent by the host country. This is a subsistence allowance, not a salary, and therefore is not related to the local minimum wage.

The amount of the accommodation fee is generally limited to the cost of food and accommodation, so if you plan to go out or travel outside of the internship, we recommend that you bring a certain amount of money with you.

Please check with your host institute or the host country's IAESTE about the date and method of payment of the accommodation fee. It is advisable to bring a certain amount of cash for immediate living expenses, as it may not always be paid immediately after internship starts.

5. Confirmation of accommodation

In principle, the host institution or the host country's IAESTE will arrange or provide information on accommodation. Depending on the host country, the address of the accommodation may not be notified in advance. Please check the O-form to see whether the accommodation costs are to be borne by the host institution or by the trainee, and contact the host country's IAESTE in if you have any questions.

6. Improvement of language skills

As a rule, IAESTE internship is conducted in English, so please make every effort to improve your English language skills. On the other hand, it is advisable to learn at least greetings in the language of the host country, as smooth and active communication can be achieved by using the language of the host country in daily life. In addition, as you will be asked many questions about Japan, you should be able to explain about our culture, customs, history, geography, etc. in English.

The IAESTE Internship Preparation Meeting is held in June and includes a language study session. The place and date of the meeting will be announced separately.

7. Make an emergency contact list

In case of illness, injury, crime, loss of passport or other accidents, make an emergency contact list and keep a printed and electronic file with you. The contact details of the local police and other contacts to be checked after arrival should be left blank for the time being and filled in after arrival. It is also advisable to prepare contact details (email and telephone numbers) for crisis management, e.g. for the Japanese office, host country's IAESTE representative, host institution representative, etc.

VI. From pre-departure to end of internship

1. Before departure

In principle, you should arrive in the host country at least one day before the start of the internship. The student in charge of the group may be contacted by the host country's IAESTE, if it provides support after arrival at the airport. Before departure, please confirm the meeting place and time at the airport, etc., and the contact details of your escort.

In the event of natural disasters, terrorism, war, epidemics, etc., the host country's IAESTE will consider whether to carry out the internship based on information from the Ministry of Foreign Affairs of the host country, WHO and other international organizations, and will promptly inform the students if it is decided to cancel the internship. If the host country's IAESTE does not decide to cancel the internship, you, your family and your university will decide whether the internship can take place or not.

2. Arrival in the host country

In principle, you are expected to go to the host institution by yourself.

Contact the host institution or the host country's IAESTE indicated in the Acceptance Notes and ask for a map and directions to the host institution and the places to visit on the first day of the internship. On arrival email the Japan Office to inform of your arrival.

If the arrival schedule changes due to flight delays or rerouting, etc., please inform the host country authorities (IAESTE, airport receptionist, accommodation, etc.) and the Japan Office as soon as possible.

3. During the internship period

Please check the emergency call number and location of the nearest hospital in case of illness or injury, and add this information to your emergency contact list. Please also make sure you know the contact details of your travel insurance company and the extent of its coverage.

If you need to be hospitalized, please inform your family, your host institution and the host country's IAESTE as soon as possible. If you wish to shorten the duration of your internship for personal reasons, please contact your host IAESTE and the Japan Office.

In case you lose your passport, contact the nearest embassy or consulate to get your passport re-issued. If you need to return to Japan without a passport, apply for a "travel document for return."

In the event of natural disasters, terrorism, war, epidemics, etc., the Japan Office will consider countermeasures based on comprehensive information and reports from the host country's IAESTE, other relevant organizations and intern.

4. Completion of internship and return to Japan

Please send an email to the JAPAN Office within one week of the completion of the internship.

Download the internship report format from the IAESTE JAPAN website, prepare your report and submit it by email. The IAESTE official internship certificate will be awarded to those who submit the report within one month of the end date of the internship.

After that, we would like to ask for your cooperation in presenting your experiences at the "Internship Reporting Meeting" and "Internship Information Sessions" for the benefit of the candidates for the following year's internship. If you are willing to cooperate, we will contact you for further details.

IAESTE student committee members in Japan lead the above-mentioned meetings and engage in activities to deepen exchanges through support for incoming interns (for details, please refer to our Instagram: https://www.instagram.com/iaeste_japan_tlsc/). If you are interested, please contact the Japan Office.

VII. In case that the internship is not implemented

1. Refund of internship administration fee

If for some reason you cannot (or will not) undertake internship after becoming a trainee candidate, the internship administration fee will be refunded, depending on the time and reason. Please refer to the table below for the refund and percentage. If in doubt, please contact the Japan Office.

Offer type	Timing	Reason		Refund
Exchange Internship	Before Matching	Declined due to the candidate's personal reasons		50%
	After Matching	Declined due to the candidate's personal reasons		N/A
		Host institution's Rejection	Withdrawal from internship	N/A
			Global Internship is requested.	N/A
		Force majeure (conflict, infectious disease, etc.)		100%
	After the acceptance letter from the host institution has been issued,	Declined due to the candidate's personal reasons		N/A
		Host institution or host country's IAESTE circumstances		30% * 1
		Force majeure (conflict, infectious disease, etc.)		100%
Global Internship	After the Japan Office has matched the offer to the candidate's request.	Declined due to the candidate's personal reasons		N/A
		Host institution's Rejection		N/A
		Force majeure (conflict, infectious disease, etc.)		100%
	After the acceptance letter from the host institution has been issued,	Declined due to the candidate's personal reasons		N/A
		Host institution's Rejection		30%
		Force majeure (conflict, infectious disease, etc.)		100%

*1: This also applies to those who wish to transfer to a Global Internship.

2 Notification of withdrawal

When the candidate withdraws for personal reasons or due to force majeure, the candidate must submit a "Notification of Withdrawal".

Please indicate your name, the date of submission, and the reason for your resignation on the notification form. After receiving the notification of withdrawal and confirming the reason for the withdrawal, a refund will be processed.



Language Certificate

The language to be tested: ☐ English ☐ French ☐ German ☐ Spanish
☐ other: (please specify)

Surname:	First name:
Nationality:	Study Course:

To be completed by the Examiner: Knowledge of Required Language

(Please tick one box for each of the language level sections below)

Excellent	Proficient User	C2	☐	Can understand with ease virtually everything heard or read. Can summarise information from different spoken and written sources, reconstructing arguments and accounts in a coherent presentation. Can express him/herself spontaneously, very fluently and precisely, differentiating finer shades of meaning even in more complex situations.
		C1	☐	Can understand a wide range of demanding, longer texts, and recognise implicit meaning. Can express him/herself fluently and spontaneously without much obvious searching for expressions. Can use language flexibly and effectively for social, academic and professional purposes. Can produce clear, well-structured, detailed text on complex subjects, showing controlled use of organisational patterns, connectors and cohesive devices.
Good	Independent User	B2	☐	Can understand the main ideas of complex texts on both concrete and abstract topics, including technical discussions in his/her field of specialisation. Can interact with a degree of fluency and spontaneity that makes regular interaction with native speakers quite possible without strain for either party. Can produce clear, detailed text on a wide range of subjects and explain a viewpoint on a topical issue, giving the advantages and disadvantages of various options.
		B1	☐	Can understand the main points of clear standard input on familiar matters regularly encountered in work, school, leisure, etc. Can deal with most situations likely to arise whilst travelling in an area where the language is spoken. Can produce simple connected text on topics which are familiar or of personal interest. Can describe experiences and events, dreams, hopes & ambitions and briefly give reasons and explanations for opinions and plans.
Fair	Basic User	A2	☐	Can understand sentences and frequently used expressions related to areas of most immediate relevance (e.g. very basic personal and family information, shopping, local geography, employment). Can communicate in simple and routine tasks requiring a simple and direct exchange of information on familiar and routine matters. Can describe in simple terms aspects of his/her background, immediate environment and matters in areas of immediate need.
Poor		A1	☐	Can understand and use familiar everyday expressions and very basic phrases aimed at the satisfaction of needs of a concrete type. Can introduce him/herself and others and can ask and answer questions about personal details such as where he/she lives, people he/she knows and things he/she has. Can interact in a simple way provided the other person talks slowly and clearly and is prepared to help.

Adapted from Global Scale – Common References Levels

Student's placement	Excellent (C1, C2) ☐	Good (B1, B2) ☐	Fair (A2) ☐	Poor (A1) ☐
Examiner:	Signature		Date	

Updated in April 2026

The International Association for the Exchange of Students for Technical Experience, Japan

Email: office@iaeste.or.jp

URL: <https://iaeste.or.jp/>

Opening Hours: Monday to Friday 10:00-17:30